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CINNOVATE SOLUTIONS (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED

CIN : U62099RJ2025OPC100267

Department Wise Audit Report

Business Development: Cocopeat

Export Markets & Japan D2C — Mohit Kumar Gupta

An independent operational review of the Business Development (Cocopeat) vertical, evaluating international outreach workflows, export fulfillment bottlenecks, cross-departmental finance gating, and lead pipeline fragmentation, prepared as part of the EF Polymer Private Limited organization-wide operational audit by Creative Upaay (brand owned by Cinnovate Solutions (OPC) Private Limited).

CLIENT	EF Polymer Private Limited
PREPARED BY	Creative Upaay
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REVIEW SCOPE	BD — Cocopeat (International Export & Japan D2C)



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SECTION 01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Report Overview — Cocopeat

Scope, current state, and headline findings

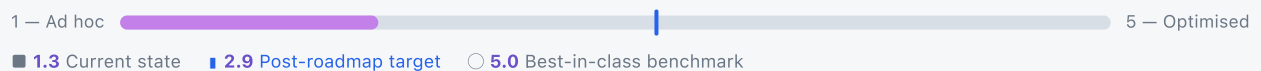
The Cocopeat vertical is an export-focused business line specializing in coconut husk-based soil-less growing media (grow bags, 5kg blocks, and pellets/coins). Target markets include the UK, Europe, and the Middle East, with a D2C launch planned in Japan within 3–4 months. Products are often customized with perlite/NPK blends for specific use cases (e.g., cannabis, horticulture) and adapted for varying EC levels (High EC for Middle East landscaping; Low EC for EU growers).

Led by Mohit Kumar Gupta, alongside a team of 3, the vertical processes outbound outreach, lead nurturing, and complex international logistics workflows. The team suffers from extreme data fragmentation due to a reliance on ad-hoc spreadsheets and multiple messaging apps (WhatsApp, WeChat, LINE). Furthermore, 40% of their effort is dedicated to manual lead sourcing.

1 Container MINIMUM ORDER QTY (MOQ)	20–25 OUTBOUND EMAILS / DAY / REP	~5% OUTREACH RESPONSE RATE	6–10 hrs INBOUND AD LEAD RESPONSE LAG	1.3 / 5.0 OVERALL MATURITY SCORE
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About the Maturity Score

A 1–5 scale measuring how systematised, documented, and independently operable the vertical is. Scored across five dimensions: Process, Technology, Data Quality, Documentation & Knowledge Management.





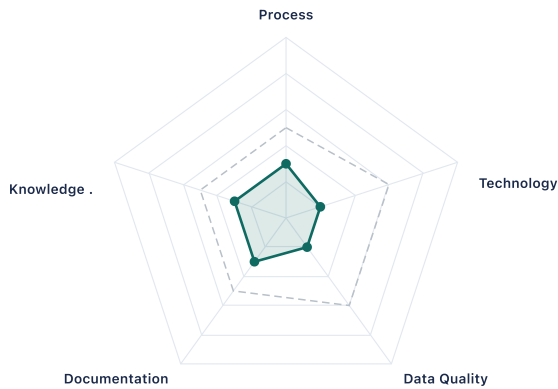
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SECTION 02 — BENCHMARKING

Department Maturity Assessment



Solid line: current state. Dashed line: target state (post-roadmap).

Cocopeat BD scores 1.3 overall — Driven by a complete absence of a CRM system, reliance on un-auditable WhatsApp/WeChat threads, and manual spreadsheet trackers. Migrating to a centralized CRM (Phase 1) and decoupling Accounts from CargoX will trigger a massive structural uplift in Data Quality and Technology utilization.

DIMENSION	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP
Process Standardization	1.5	2.5	1.0
Technology Utilization	1.0	3.0	2.0
Data Quality & Accessibility	1.0	3.0	2.0
Documentation	1.5	2.5	1.0
Knowledge Management	1.5	2.5	1.0
Overall	1.3	2.9	1.6



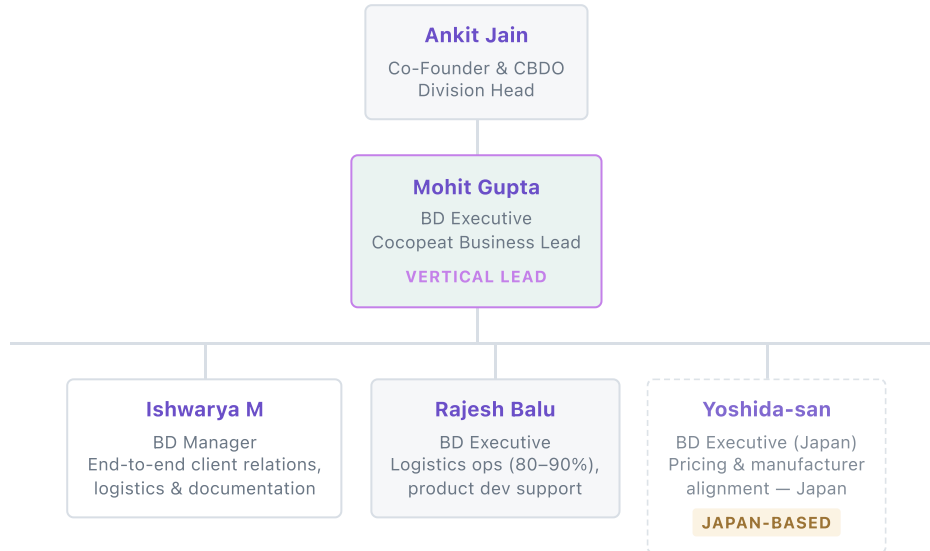
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Team Structure

Reporting hierarchy within Cocopeat Business, operating under Ankit Jain (Co-Founder & CBDO).



Tools in Use



Google Sheets / Excel

Ad-hoc pipeline tracking — sourced leads, follow-up status, and inbound landing page queries. Custom dashboard built by Mohit (~7 days before audit).



Gmail (Primary Domain)

Cold outbound (20-25 emails/day/rep) + client replies + internal comms — all sharing one company domain with no warm-up or inbox separation.



LinkedIn

Multi-touch outreach including connection requests and case studies.



Dripify

Outreach automation (subscription lapsed at time of audit).



WhatsApp

Primary communication channel for Middle East/UAE trading company contacts.



WeChat

Primary communication channel for China trading company contacts.



LINE

Primary communication channel for Japan trading company contacts.



CargoX

Export document upload platform. Gated behind Accounts payment clearance; uploads must occur within 10 days of container arrival at destination port.



Google Ads

Search lead generation campaigns managed by external agency.



LinkedIn Ads

B2B lead generation campaigns managed by external agency.



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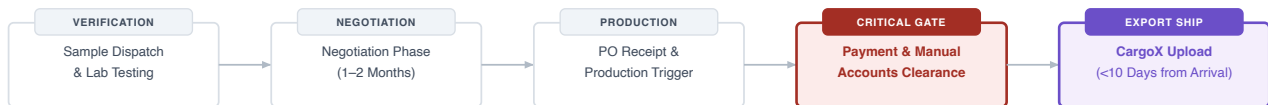
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SECTION 03 — CURRENT WORKFLOWS & PROCESS MAPS

Current Workflows

Analysis of current operational sequences

Order Fulfillment & Shipment Process — P-01



What is good: The sequential export lifecycle is logically ordered — sample verification feeds negotiation, which feeds PO, which feeds production and then shipment. Clients test before committing to a full container, reducing costly surprises.

Detailed Workflow Steps:

- 1. Verification:** Sample dispatch and lab testing (verifying EC levels/expansion volumes) to establish buyer confidence.
- 2. Negotiation:** A 1–2 months phase discussing product specs, custom chemical blends (perlite/NPK), and pricing.
- 3. Embassy Permits (Egypt/Peru/Spain):** Customer submits PI to embassy to obtain local import permits (e.g., ACID numbers in Egypt), taking 20–25 days.
- 4. Production Trigger:** Purchase Order (PO) receipt triggers factory manufacturing in Coimbatore and container logistics booking.
- 5. Payment Clearance:** Hard gate where the Accounts team manually checks and clears advance payments.
- 6. CargoX Upload:** Documentation team uploads shipping documents to CargoX (within 10 days of vessel arrival at destination port).

What needs to be fixed: CargoX document upload is gated behind Accounts payment clearance. Any delay in clearance confirmation pushes the upload past the mandatory 10-day arrival window, triggering demurrage fees.

Bottlenecks: For Egypt, Peru, and Spain: a 20–25 day wait for local import permits (ACID numbers) precedes CargoX eligibility, compressing the already-tight 10-day upload window further.

Dependencies: Finance/Accounts must confirm payment in real-time for BD to proceed with CargoX. Logistics must book the container and track arrival date. Any break in this chain risks demurrage.

Sourcing & Outreach Workflow — P-02



What is good: Outreach is structured with timezone awareness (e.g., China contacts at 07:00 IST, UK/US contacts after 17:00 IST). Connection requests and initial outbound sequences were automated via ****Dripify**** (integrated directly with Mohit's profile) before the subscription lapsed. ****Obverse**** (external agency) actively manages Google and LinkedIn Ads targeting UK, Europe, and Middle East B2B channels.

Detailed Workflow Steps:

- 1. Lead Generation:** External agency ****Obverse**** drives inbound leads via Google and LinkedIn Ads landing on a web form, while the internal team manually scrapes databases (~40% bandwidth).
- 2. Automated Connection (lapsed):** Dripify used to send connection requests and a multi-touch follow-up sequence (connection → case study → 3–4 follow-ups); with the subscription lapsed, these steps are now handled manually.
- 3. Manual Takeover:** Once a lead replies, the (former) Dripify sequence immediately halted, requiring Mohit to manually handle further messaging.
- 4. Direct Channel Outreach:** Direct manual follow-ups are conducted over email, WhatsApp, and WeChat (critical for China,

where Google and WhatsApp are banned).

5. **Spreadsheet Logging:** Qualified leads and conversation status are manually copied and logged into ad-hoc Google Sheets.

What needs to be fixed: No CRM — all pipeline data lives in ad-hoc Google Sheets/Excel with no unified view across sourced leads, landing page inquiries, and LinkedIn responses. Inbound ad leads sit uncontacted for 6–10 hours due to timezone gaps. Dripify automatically stops on replies, requiring manual takeover.

Bottlenecks: Manual lead sourcing consumes ~40% of team bandwidth. Dripify LinkedIn automation subscription has lapsed, forcing manual follow-up sequences. WeChat must be operated manually for Chinese buyers due to country-level communication restrictions.

Dependencies: R&D must provide lab reports and technical test data to support international client qualification. Design provides packaging artwork for white-label clients. Both are ad-hoc with no SLA.



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APPENDIX — CROSS-DEPARTMENT DEPENDENCIES

Cross-Department Dependencies

Findings and recommendations that require action outside the BD (Cocopeat) vertical to resolve.

Finance & Accounts

CRITICAL GATING

OPERATIONS DEPENDENCY

CargoX export document upload is gated behind payment confirmation from Accounts. BD cannot proceed without explicit clearance — no API or dashboard visibility exists today.

 Key Person: Shobha Shekhawat (Finance)

CRITICAL BOTTLENECK

Manual clearance emails create unpredictable delays. If the 10-day CargoX upload window is missed, demurrage fees become inevitable — with no automated alert to warn BD in time.

DATA TRANSFER & ACTION NEEDED

Accounts must push a real-time payment status flag to BD and Logistics the moment payment clears — via dashboard integration or automated WhatsApp/Slack notification. BD should never need to chase Accounts manually.

R&D

TECHNICAL SUPPORT

OPERATIONS DEPENDENCY

International clients require lab test reports and technical certifications before and after sample dispatch. BD cannot qualify or close deals without R&D's turnaround on these reports.

 Key Person: Ritu Panwar (R&D Lead)

CRITICAL BOTTLENECK

No formal SLA exists for R&D lab report delivery. QC-level queries take a minimum of 28–30 hours. BD has no visibility into queue status, stalling client qualification timelines.

DATA TRANSFER & ACTION NEEDED

R&D must maintain a shared tracker of pending BD lab requests with SLA commitments. Completed reports must be pushed to a shared Drive folder, not delivered ad-hoc via WhatsApp.

Logistics

FULFILLMENT DEPENDENCY

OPERATIONS DEPENDENCY

Container booking, port arrival tracking, and customs clearance timelines must be visible to BD to accurately forecast delivery commitments to international clients.

 Key Person: Nihal Paliwal (Logistics)

CRITICAL BOTTLENECK

Container arrival dates are not proactively shared with BD. The 10-day CargoX window countdown begins upon arrival — with BD often finding out too late to act within the window.

DATA TRANSFER & ACTION NEEDED

Logistics must auto-notify BD via WhatsApp/dashboard the moment a container arrives at destination port. BD needs live shipping status, not periodic updates, to manage the CargoX clock.



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SECTION 04 — OPERATIONAL PAIN POINTS

Pain Points Register

Ranked by operational impact. Each pain point is cross-referenced to its recommendation in Section 06.

Priority Focus Areas:

- ① **CargoX Export Documentation Gating** — The CargoX upload window is gated behind manual Accounts payment clearance. Any delay pushes the shipment past the 10-day arrival window, triggering demurrage fees.
- ② **Lead Pipeline Fragmentation** — 40% of team effort is consumed by manual lead sourcing with no CRM. Inbound ad leads sit uncontacted for 6–10 hours due to timezone gaps, and all pipeline data lives in siloed spreadsheets.

	PAIN POINT	IMPACT	EVIDENCE FROM AUDIT
P-01	CargoX Gating Bottleneck. Export docs must be uploaded to CargoX within 10 days of container arrival, but are gated behind Accounts payment clearance.	CRITICAL	Risks heavy demurrage fees if the 10-day window is missed. Cross-departmental coordination is crucial and entirely manual today.
P-02	Country-Specific Regulatory Delays. Markets like Egypt, Peru, and Spain require local import permits (e.g., ACID numbers) before CargoX uploads are permitted.	HIGH	Adds a 20–25 day delay to the export lifecycle, straining logistics planning and compressing the CargoX upload window further.
P-03	Ad-to-Lead Response Lag. Response delays of 6–10 hours for inbound queries from paid Google/LinkedIn ads due to time zone differences.	HIGH	Lost high-intent opportunities as leads go cold before contact. Paid ad spend is wasted on leads that are never followed up in time.
P-04	Email Deliverability Risk. Cold outbound outreach (20–25 emails/day per mailbox) shares the primary company domain.	HIGH	High risk of main domain blacklisting, disrupting internal and client communications across the entire company.
P-05	Disconnected Lead Pipelines. Sourced leads, landing page inquiries, and LinkedIn messages are tracked in siloed, manual spreadsheets.	MEDIUM	Prevents unified pipeline visibility and introduces manual tracking errors. No single source of truth exists for deal status.



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SECTION 05 — TIME & EFFORT

Time & Effort Allocation

Based on a standard 8-hour workday. Hours shown are estimates per team member per day, averaged across the team.

ACTIVITY	SHARE OF TEAM TIME	EST. TIME / DAY
Outbound Lead Sourcing (Google, AI tools, export databases, exhibitions)	~40%	~3.2 hrs
Lead Nurturing, Follow-ups & Sample Coordination	~25%	~2.0 hrs
Logistics & Documentation (CargoX, export docs, container tracking)	~20%	~1.6 hrs
Cross-Department Coordination (Accounts, Logistics, Production, R&D)	~15%	~1.2 hrs

Key Observation:

Rajesh Balu, nominally a BD Executive, devotes only **10–20%** of his actual effort to BD tasks. The remaining **80–90%** is consumed by logistics operations and product development support — effectively making him a logistics resource. This critically understates the actual BD headcount available for lead generation.



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SECTION 06 — CORRECTIVE ACTION PLAN

Recommended Solution

This section outlines the integrated technology solution proposed to resolve operational bottlenecks, replacing the legacy recommendations register.

Solution Modules to be Built:

1 Cross-Department Clearance & Export Documentation

- **Real-Time Clearance Dashboard:** A shared dashboard with live API integration to Accounts, showing payment clearance status instantly to BD and Logistics. CargoX upload is decoupled from manual approval chasing.
- **Regulatory Buffer Engine:** Automated 25-day buffer calculation built into production and logistics timelines specifically for Egypt, Peru, and Spain orders (ACID permit approvals), preventing premature container booking.
- **Automated Alerts:** WhatsApp/Slack notifications the moment payment clears or a container arrives at the destination port, protecting the 10-day CargoX upload window.

2 CRM Migration & Automated Lead Pipeline

- **Centralized CRM:** Migrate lead tracking from ad-hoc spreadsheets to a unified CRM consolidating sourced leads, landing page inquiries, and LinkedIn responses into a single pipeline view.
- **Automated Lead Capture:** An AI agent or automated WhatsApp/Email trigger that instantly qualifies and books meetings for inbound ad leads across time zones, eliminating the 6–10 hour response lag.
- **Unified Messaging:** WhatsApp/WeChat/LINE threads integrated directly into the CRM, creating an auditable communication trail instead of siloed app conversations.

3 Outbound Domain Protection & Deliverability

- **Secondary Domain Infrastructure:** Acquire and warm up dedicated secondary domains for Cocopeat cold outbound emails, isolating outreach traffic from the primary company domain.
- **Deliverability Monitoring:** Automated inbox reputation tracking and warm-up protocols to maintain sending health and protect internal/client communications from blacklisting risk.

What Remains the Same

- **No New Backend Database:** CRM sits on top of existing data flows; existing pipeline sheets feed into the new system.
- **Familiar Outreach Cadence:** The team retains its structured multi-touch outreach approach; only the domain and tracking layer changes.

Tech Stack Utilized

- **CRM:** Custom on React JS
- **APIs:** Google Sheets, WhatsApp Business, CargoX, Gmail
- **AI:** LLM-based lead qualification & response agent
- **Domain:** Secondary domains with warm-up infrastructure

Key Operational Problems Solved

- Eliminates demurrage risk by providing real-time Accounts clearance visibility and automated CargoX alerts.
- Captures high-intent inbound leads instantly across time zones, removing the 6–10 hour response lag.
- Unifies all lead pipelines (sourced, ad, LinkedIn) into a single auditable CRM with no manual tracking errors.
- Protects the primary company domain from outbound blacklisting by isolating cold email traffic.

Future Scope of Improvement / Enhancement

- **Japan D2C Launch:** Fully localized D2C retail operations (Amazon Japan / branded website) to capture direct consumer demand alongside the existing B2B export pipeline.
- **Predictive Lead Scoring:** AI-driven scoring of outbound prospects based on historical conversion data and market signals to prioritize high-value targets.

Next Steps for Team Adoption

- **Mandatory CRM Training:** All BD team members must complete onboarding on the new CRM and automated lead capture workflows before go-live.
- **Feedback Loop:** Establish a continuous feedback loop to iterate on the solution on the ground, ensuring it genuinely adapts to the team's operational reality and achieves actual adoption.



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SECTION 07 — IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

Phased Roadmap

Initiatives sequenced across three phases, with quantified ROI and scope of work per phase

INITIATIVE		PHASE 1 WEEKS 1–4	PHASE 2 WEEKS 5–9	PHASE 3 WEEKS 10–12
CRM Migration & Pipeline Unification	Module 2	●		
Accounts/CargoX Clearance Dashboard	Module 1	●		
Secondary Domains & Warm-up	Module 3	●		
Automated Inbound Lead Capture	Module 2		●	
Regulatory Buffer Integration	Module 1			●

Phase 1 — Visibility & Safety

Weeks 1–4 · High priority

Maturity 1.3 → 1.8

SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Migrate lead tracking from ad-hoc spreadsheets to a centralized CRM (Module 2).
- **Build:** Integrate Accounts clearance dashboard to decouple CargoX upload from manual approvals (Module 1).
- **Build:** Acquire and warm up secondary domains for Cocopeat cold outbound emails (Module 3).
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** Google Sheets API CargoX Integration .
- **Team Adoption:** Conduct CRM onboarding sessions for all BD team members.
- **Client To-Do:** Provide Accounts clearance workflow details, existing lead tracking sheets, and approve domain acquisition budget.

100%

PIPELINE VIS

No lost deals or manual tracking errors.

0

DEMURRAGE RISK

Protected CargoX upload windows.

Secured

DOMAIN SAFETY

Protected from outbound blacklisting.

Phase 2 — Scale & Automation

Weeks 5–9 · Operational discipline

Maturity 1.8 → 2.5

SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Implement an AI agent/automated trigger to qualify and book meetings for inbound leads instantly (Module 2).
- **Build:** Integrate unified messaging (WhatsApp/WeChat/LINE) directly into the CRM.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** LLM APIs WhatsApp Business API WeChat / LINE Connectors .
- **Team Adoption:** Train team on AI-assisted lead qualification and automated response workflows.
- **Client To-Do:** Provide historical inbound lead conversion data and define qualification criteria for the AI agent.

< 5m

RESPONSE TIME

Eliminates the 6–10 hr timezone lag.

100%

CONTACT RETENTION

Protects against employee turnover.

Phase 3 — Strategic Integration

Weeks 10–12 · Heavy effort

Maturity 2.5 → 2.9

SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Build a 25-day regulatory buffer into production timelines specifically for Egypt/Peru/Spain ACID permits (Module 1).
- **Build:** Launch fully localized D2C retail operations (Amazon/Website) in Japan.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** **Production Scheduling API** **Amazon Seller Central API** .
- **Team Adoption:** Train team on regulatory buffer workflows and D2C fulfillment processes.
- **Client To-Do:** Provide production lead times for regulatory markets and approve Japan D2C launch plan.

0 Days
IDLE INVENTORY

Perfected JIT manufacturing alignment.

Live
D2C REVENUE

New retail channels active in Japan.



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SECTION 08 — RETURN ON INVESTMENT (ROI)

System Impact: Before & After

Measurable improvements post-implementation

CATEGORY	BEFORE (CURRENT STATE)	AFTER (POST-IMPLEMENTATION)
Export Documentation	CargoX uploads gated behind manual Accounts clearance emails; demurrage risk if 10-day window is missed.	Real-Time Clearance Dashboard. Automated payment status flags; zero demurrage risk.
Lead Pipeline	Siloed spreadsheets across sourced leads, ad inquiries, and LinkedIn; no unified view.	Centralized CRM. All leads in a single pipeline with 100% visibility and no manual tracking errors.
Inbound Lead Response	6–10 hour response lag due to timezone gaps; high-intent leads go cold.	AI Lead Capture Agent. Instant qualification and meeting booking across time zones (< 5 min response).
Email Deliverability	Cold outbound shares primary company domain; high blacklisting risk.	Secondary Domain Infrastructure. Outbound traffic isolated; primary domain fully protected.
Regulatory Compliance	No buffer for ACID permit delays (Egypt, Peru, Spain); premature container booking.	Automated Regulatory Buffer. 25-day buffer built into timelines; zero idle inventory.
Communication Audit Trail	Un-auditable WhatsApp/WeChat/LINE threads with no centralized record.	Unified Messaging in CRM. All client conversations logged and searchable within the CRM.
Department Maturity Score	1.3 / 5.0 (Ad-hoc)	2.9 / 5.0 (Systematised)

Quantified Executive Time Savings

Estimated annual bandwidth reclaimed for the Cocopeat BD Lead by eliminating manual CargoX clearance follow-ups and timezone lag.

100% PIPELINE VISIBILITY	< 5 min INBOUND LEAD RESPONSE	10 hrs MONTHLY TIME SAVED	120 hrs ANNUAL HOURS SAVED
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Bandwidth Reinvestment Breakdown:

- Current Friction:** Lead manual follow-ups on CargoX clearance emails and manually qualifying international inbound leads across 6–10 hour timezone gaps.
- Automated Efficiency:** Real-time Accounts Clearance Dashboard and AI Lead Capture Agent automate payment checks and instant lead booking.

- **Strategic Impact:** Reclaims **120 BD hours per year (~15 full working days)** to focus on expanding global distributor networks and D2C channels.